

MEETING IN GARDEN SCORES U. S. COURT

**Civil Rights Congress Rally
Protests Jailing of 4 Men
in Red Trial Here**

Protest against the jailing of four of the eleven Communist leaders on trial in the Federal court for conspiracy was voiced by speakers and in resolutions at a rally last night in Madison Square Garden under the sponsorship of the Civil Rights Congress of New York.

The speakers included Eugene Dennis, general secretary of the Communist party in the United States, one of the defendants in the conspiracy trial; C. B. Baldwin, national secretary of the Progressive party; Albert Maltz, novelist and film writer; William L. Patterson, executive secretary of the Civil Rights Congress; Paul Robeson, singer, and Mrs. Bessie Mitchell, sister of one of the six Negroes now appealing a death sentence in New Jersey.

The Communist party does not have to have any fear for itself, Eugene Dennis said, declaring that "under any and all conditions, we will know how to preserve our party's honor and integrity, replenish its ranks, and strengthen its fighting capacity." Mr. Dennis referred to the proceedings in the Federal court and said:

"In this trial the elementary democratic rights of all Americans are at stake. And the administration, court and prosecution are in a hurry to have done with us Communist defendants, and with all democratic rights."

Mr. Baldwin said that if President Truman was really concerned about civil liberties he would halt the trial of the Communist leaders. He characterized the Communist trial as "a fight for self-preservation by every non-Communist

who prizes the rights of freedom of speech."

He quoted Henry Wallace as having said that in every Fascist nation suppression of the Communists has led to suppression of all other minorities and that violence both in this country and elsewhere has been committed by the very persons who would suppress the other groups with whom they disagreed.

Mr. Patterson warned that if "the unconstitutional war upon the Communists succeeds, every remaining progressive organization will be labeled a Communist Front and smashed." He said that only the unity of strength of Negro and white Americans could guarantee the enforcement of constitutional liberties and secure inviolate civil and human rights.

Mrs. Mitchell praised the Civil Rights Congress for its program.

"The Congress has taught me that Negroes and whites can get together to stop lynchings," she said.

Mr. Maltz declared that books were on trial in the United States and that what was being decided now was whether this nation belonged to the people or whether it belonged to Government officials and the Federal Bureau of Investigation.

Reid Robinson, international vice president of the Mine, Mill and Smelter Workers Union, CIO, said the real energies of this Administration and Congress were devoted to "smearing," spy scares, red baiting and witch hunting.

Mr. Robeson said that all American progressives should "stand back of the Communists now on trial." He reported on his recent trip to Europe, where he said communism is continuing to make gains. He described the Communist party as the only one that is for peace and opposed to war.

The resolutions demanded the immediate release of the defendants in the conspiracy trial and called on President Truman "to end immediately the indictment of the Communist leaders."

A mock trial was presented at the rally in which those whom the Civil Rights Congress branded as "criminals" because of their "destruction of civil and human rights" appeared as defendants.